

YOUR PRESENTATION IS MORE THAN SLIDES

(5)TIPS

FOR **UNIVERSITY STUDENTS**
BY A GRAPHIC DESIGNER
& MARKETING GRADUATE



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A presentation is a curated **experience** you design.

Your audience might be excited, distracted, or even thinking about their own presentation coming up next. That's fine.

What matters is whether the energy you bring and the rhythm you control can carry your idea across to an audience with different mindsets, expectations, and levels of attention.

This guide is based on my experience as a graphic designer and marketing graduate, from student presentations to real-world pitches, and how presentations are designed to shape attention and perception.

(01)

IT'S ALL
ABOUT

> RHYTHM

A good presentation isn't about cramming more content. It's about **pacing**.

Don't rush.

Give your audience time to process, breathe, and follow your thinking. Your speaking speed should feel natural.

Rhythm isn't flat.

Speed up when it matters. Your opening should pull people in. Your key moments should build momentum and energy.

Think of it like editing a video. You control when to slow down, and when to hit.

(02)

PRESENT
LIKE **TIKTOK**
NOT A
LECTURE



A presentation is to **sell your idea** rather than deliver a lecture.

Ask yourself:

**Would people stay if this were a
TikTok / Instagram reel?**

Beyond a hook in every section,
somewhere in the middle, you can
create some moments that people will
remember. These could be:

- a sharp insight
- a clear visual
- a bit of humour
- or your core feature presented in a compelling / attractive way

(03)

Presenter



audience

**SWITCH
ROLES
TO THE
AUDIENCE**

Record your presentation. Watch it back like an audience.

**Record your practice / rehearsal,
individually or as a group.**

Pay attention to your pacing, clarity,
and transitions while watching.

**Let your teammates watch your
part too.** They'll catch what you miss.

Then forget that it's yours.

Watch it as if you've never heard this
idea before. Be empathetic:

- Does it make sense?
- Can you follow the story?
- Would you stay engaged?
- Does it feel natural and comfortable to listen to?

Design for what your audience **cares about**.

It's sad but... not everything that matters to you matters to your audience.

Think about what your audience actually cares about. Does a certain detail help them understand your idea, or are you adding it because you're attached to it?

It's easy to treat your project like your own child, full of ideas, details, and idealism. That's natural, I do it too. But it can work against you in the presentation.

Not everything needs to be said. Sometimes, removing a sentence improves the rhythm more than adding one. A clear, comfortable flow matters more than squeezing in everything you want to say.

(04)

SLIDES
ARE NOT
YOUR
~~Script~~

Slides are **visual aids** to support what you say, not an essay on a screen.

A QUICK NOTE

Why is there so much text here? Because this is a guide, not a presentation deck.

If your audience is reading, they're not listening.

Design slides for the actual environment:

- Is the font readable from the back of the room and under the actual lighting?
- Will anything be cropped at the edges?
- Does screen or projection distortion affect your layout?

(05)

EVERY
TOUCHPOINT
IS DESIGNED

Beyond the visual design of your slides, **the way you speak** is part of your design.

Consider how you craft these sentences:

- your core message
- your transitions
- the statements you don't want people to miss

Transitions and logic also need to be designed. Think about how you guide your audience with logic:

- “So...”
- “This leads us to...”
- “Building upon this problem...”

Your presentation is timed (likely). So every sentence needs to be sharp, intentional, and on point.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ **BE CONFIDENT.** You own this presentation. You know it better than anyone else.
- ☐ **CONTROL THE RHYTHM.** Don't rush.
- ☐ **THINK LIKE TIKTOK.** Keep it engaging. Make at least one moment memorable.
- ☐ **RECORD YOUR REHEARSAL.** Watch it back as an audience.
- ☐ **SAY ONLY WHAT MATTERS.**
- ☐ **SLIDES ARE YOUR VISUAL AIDS.** Don't let them replace you.
- ☐ **EVERYTHING IS DESIGNED.** How you articulate your sentences matters.

THE END

These are just simple principles. But they scale beyond the classroom.

You don't have to take it all in now. **Come back to this** when you need it.

GOOD LUCK



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